

Oct 6, 2025

Meeting Oct 6, 2025 at 15:18 CEST

Meeting records Recording

Summary

The AI and Automation Club, a voluntary program announced by Stephan Bayer, aims to provide participants with deep insights into AI and automation, emphasizing these as cross-functional skills relevant to all professions. Clément Lacaille and Ct Lac outlined the practical, no-coding approach of the course, focusing on hands-on application, problem-solving with AI, and mastering communication with AI through a five-ingredient prompting framework. Participants engaged in an individual activity to create a social media script using this framework, with Clément Lacaille demonstrating how to improve prompts with AI assistance and co-build them with an LLM.

Details

Notes Length: Standard

- **Course Language and Accessibility** Stephan Bayer addressed a question regarding the course's language, stating it is conducted in English for everyone, not exclusively for native speakers. He suggested utilizing subtitles during live sessions or automatic German subtitles in recordings for better comprehension. Stephan also mentioned the possibility of conducting the course in German in the future.
- **AI and Automation Club Overview** Stephan Bayer announced the AI and Automation Club as a voluntary, extra program, emphasizing that it is not curriculum-aligned but offers a certificate. The club aims to delve deeply into AI

and automation, highlighting these as cross-team, cross-job, and cross-company skills relevant to all professions, not just programmers or marketing managers.

- **Learning Opportunity in AI** Stephan Bayer explained that AI and automation present a rare historical opportunity for newcomers in the tech job market to quickly gain skills on par with experienced professionals due to the technology's novelty and rapid evolution. He noted that while AI has been present for a while, it is still changing fast, necessitating a flexible learning approach rather than a rigid curriculum.
- **Weekly Structure and Learning Approach** Stephan Bayer outlined the weekly structure, with meetings every Monday to discuss an automation scenario to be built by Friday. Participants are encouraged to customize and rebuild these automations in their own browsers. He also highlighted that successful engagement in the job market increasingly requires knowledge of AI and automation, making participants special in a competitive field.
- **Market Evolution and Course Empowerment** Ct Lac emphasized that the market is rapidly evolving, making continuous self-learning and searching habits crucial. Ct Lac explained that the course aims to empower individuals to identify AI opportunities within their own jobs, focusing on automation and agentic AI regardless of their profession.
- **Practical, No-Coding Approach** Ct Lac detailed that Sai, the teacher, will guide participants through automation workflows without requiring coding, focusing instead on understanding new AI concepts and their applications. The course will involve building usable artifacts each week, with a strong emphasis on hands-on application and problem-solving using AI.
- **Instructor Background and Core Skills** Clément Lacaille, an industry practitioner, shared their background in coaching MNC leaders and running an AI content firm, emphasizing that coding is not a prerequisite for the course. Clément highlighted that the course's focus is on mastering first-principles thinking, breaking down problems, and communicating effectively with AI.
- **Three Pillars of Learning** Clément Lacaille outlined three key learning pillars: thinking from a systems point of view to break down problems into smaller steps before considering automation; mastering communication with AI to provide clear context and elicit desired outputs; and building agents to solve real-world problems. They also stressed the importance of consistency and practice for effective learning.

- **Course Projects and Outcomes** Clément Lacaille detailed the weekly projects, including creating a social media video automation using Zapier in Week 1, personalizing CVs and cover letters with n8n in Week 2, developing personal AI voice assistants in Week 3, and building a personal branding agent for LinkedIn automation in Week 4. The course aims to instill a problem-solving mindset and practical skills for building AI-powered solutions.
- **Daily Schedule and Learning Philosophy** Stephan Bayer clarified that the daily lectures run from 4 to 6 PM German time, Monday to Friday, with recordings available for those who miss live sessions. Stephan underscored that learning AI is primarily achieved through hands-on practice, not just by watching videos, to enable participants to showcase their work to future employers.
- **Access to Resources and Tools** Stephan Bayer confirmed that recordings and course materials would be linked in the "AIA Club" Slack channel. Clément Lacaille outlined the primary tools to be used, including Zapier, n8n, OpenAI, Chatbot UI, ElevenLabs, and various data management tools, with an emphasis on practical application.
- **Prompt Engineering Fundamentals** Clément Lacaille introduced prompting as the art of giving clear instructions to AI, likening it to communicating with a random stranger who needs precise context. They presented a five-ingredient framework for effective prompts: role, context, task, output, and constraints.
- **Applying the Prompting Framework** Clément Lacaille demonstrated the prompting framework through examples, showing how detailed prompts for music recommendations and professional emails yield more relevant and customized outputs than generic queries. Clément also introduced "chain prompting," an iterative process of refining prompts based on AI outputs.
- **Interactive Activity: Social Media Script Creation** Clément Lacaille initiated a hands-on activity where participants, working in breakout rooms, applied the five-component prompting framework to create a social media video script for a local eco-friendly product. Participants were instructed to document their prompts and AI outputs in a shared Google document for visibility and collaborative learning.
- **Breakout Room Issues** Clément Lacaille attempted to open 20 breakout rooms for a 15-18 minute session, but participants experienced difficulties joining. Despite efforts to resolve the issue, including Clément Lacaille sharing their screen to demonstrate settings, the problem persisted. Ultimately, Clément

Lacaille closed the rooms and decided everyone would work independently for the day, with plans to resolve the technical issues for the next session.

- **Individual Activity and Assignment** Due to the technical issues with breakout rooms, Clément Lacaille instructed participants to work individually on an assignment. They provided two documents in the chat box: one detailing the scenario to be solved and another for participants to paste their prompts and outputs. The task involved constructing a five-component prompt based on a discussed framework and entering both the prompt and its output into chatbot UI or ChatGPT, then posting them in the chat box.
- **Prompt Framework Explanation** Shahmahmood Nezami, who joined late, received a quick briefing on the prompt framework from Clément Lacaille, which consists of "role, context, task, and output". Clément Lacaille elaborated on each component, explaining "role" as defining AI's persona, "context" as the situation to be solved, "task" as the specific action for AI, and "output" as the desired format, including constraints.
- **Scenario for Prompt Construction** Participants were tasked with creating a 2-3 minute video script for an eco-friendly product launch of a local business, using the five-component prompt framework. Clément Lacaille clarified that the company and product details could be chosen by the participant, and those without chatbot UI access should use ChatGPT.
- **Troubleshooting Chatbot UI Input** Jimmy Carmelo Garcia Martinez asked how to create a multi-line input in the chatbot UI without immediate responses, as they wanted to structure their prompt with multiple points. Kai Feldhoff provided the solution, explaining that pressing "Shift + Enter" allows for new lines within the input field.
- **Review of Submitted Prompts** Clément Lacaille reviewed some submitted prompts, highlighting a good example of an Instagram post for an eco-friendly brand launching a reusable water bottle. They emphasized the importance of including examples in the five-component framework, stating that "example" is the single most valuable component for achieving desired outputs from AI.
- **Improving Prompts with AI Assistance** Clément Lacaille demonstrated how to use AI to improve prompts by first giving the AI the framework context. They then pasted a participant's prompt and asked the AI for suggestions on how to improve it, receiving feedback on strengthening the role, being more specific

about the product, and clarifying the task. This showcased how AI can serve as a "mentor" or "peer" for co-creating and brainstorming prompts.

- **Co-Building Prompts with LLM** Clément Lacaille illustrated a "questioning approach" to co-build a prompt with an LLM by starting with a basic request and allowing the AI to ask guiding questions. The LLM prompted for details such as the AI's desired role, tone, product specifics, target audience, location, main goal, and output format and constraints, leading to a highly customized and detailed script. The resulting script included specific scene directions, camera movements, character descriptions, and voice-over lines, making it suitable for direct use in video production.
- **Future Course Activities** Clément Lacaille (Ct Lac) provided a glimpse into future activities, explaining that participants would learn to build workflows using Zapier, which integrates AI and non-AI nodes for automation. They demonstrated examples such as automating presentation and document creation from client requirements and extracting phone numbers from Google Drive files using AI. Clément Lacaille then discussed plans to build an automation to generate video scripts using OpenAI and then create AI video avatars using tools like HeyGen, highlighting the significant cost reduction and efficiency gains in content creation.
- **Hands-On Learning and Practice** Clément Lacaille encouraged participants to practice what they learned in the session to consolidate their understanding. They stressed the importance of hands-on engagement and invited participants to share their prompts and outputs on Slack for further discussion and learning. Clément Lacaille offered to stay after the call for 10 more minutes to assist anyone facing issues with Chatbot UI or other questions.
- **Demo Key Limitations** Naim Burrack inquired about potential limitations of the demo key, specifically if it has an unlimited usage or if there are restrictions. Clément Lacaille clarified that while there is currently a limit of \$20 per week for the demo key, this can be increased if usage exceeds the limit. They also advised users to prioritize text-based interactions over image and video generation, as text is less costly.
- **Usage Guidelines for Demo Key** Clément Lacaille advised users to use the demo key for prompting and text-related activities, explicitly stating not to use it for images and videos due to higher costs. Naim Burrack acknowledged this

guidance and confirmed they wouldn't use it for those purposes. Clément Lacaille also encouraged users to utilize the key freely but not to spam it.

- **Meeting Conclusion** The meeting concluded with participants expressing gratitude and looking forward to the next session. Naim Burrack described the session as a "nice icebreaker lesson". Clément Lacaille thanked everyone and prepared to stop the recording.

Suggested next steps

- ☐ Clément Lacaille will figure out the technicalities of the breakout rooms and come back with a better option tomorrow.
- ☐ Clément Lacaille will give access to chatbot UI later.
- ☐ The group will practice what they learned today and try a couple of scenarios in their free time and come back tomorrow with a better understanding.

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